Table 2.4 `XMLHttpRequest` **event handlers** ***(continued)***

Event handler	Function
`ontimeout`	Fires if the code set a timeout value, and that timeout has been exceeded. If your code sets a timeout of 10,000 milliseconds (10 seconds), this event handler will fire if the response hasn't been received after 10 seconds. If `ontimeout` fires, the `onload` and `onerror` event handlers will not fire.
`onprogress`	Monitors progress of a request or response. It's most helpful in the context of uploading or downloading binary data, such as an image. If you're uploading an image to a website, `onprogress` can be used to create a progress indicator showing how much of the image has been uploaded.
`onreadystatechange`	Fires when the request changes states. The `XMLHttpRequest` spec defines five states a request can be in: unset, opened, headers received, loading, and done. The value of the ready state is stored in the `XMLHttpRequest` object's `readyState` property. For example, when a request goes from loading to done, its `readyState` changes from 3 to 4 (the numeric values for loading and done, respectively), and `onreadystatechange` fires.

When the `XMLHttpRequest` spec was first devised, `onreadystate` was the only event handler available. Now that there are much finer-grained events available, you're better off using them.

2.3.3 Including cookies on cross-origin requests

Many websites need a way of identifying the user visiting the page. If you check your email using Gmail, Gmail needs some way of knowing who you are so that it can load your emails.

Websites can identify users through *user credentials*, a general term for any bit of information that can identify a user. The most popular form of user credentials is the cookie. Servers will use cookies to store a unique ID that identifies the user. The browser then includes this cookie on every request to the server.

> **NOTE** Same-origin HTTP requests will always contain the cookie in the request. In contrast, cross-origin requests don't include cookies by default.

Cookies can be included on cross-origin requests by setting the `XMLHttpRequest`'s `withCredentials` property to `true`. Setting the `withCredentials` property to `true` indicates that user credentials such as cookies, basic authentication information, or client-side Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) certificates should be included on cross-origin requests. The following code snippet shows an example of setting the `withCredentials` property to `true`:

```
xhr.withCredentials = true;
```